

making those decisions, and learn to trust our own judgement even when we know that it's led us astray before – and that can be really hard to do.

When I finished paying off the personal debt that forced me to confront my relationship with money, it coincided with some really lucrative opportunities, which meant that I was earning more than I had ever done before. For such a long time I'd had this one main goal, one main purpose – fixing my past mistakes and paying off my credit cards. It had been more or less my sole focus, and while I'd found a path to financial wellbeing for the duration of that journey, suddenly having more money and no debt to pay off was both exhilarating and terrifying. Even though I knew that I had successfully managed to transform my relationship with money in so many ways, I worried about whether my commitment to healthier finances would waver now I'd achieved that goal, and being responsible for more money made me nervous. What if I made those same mistakes again? After all, we all know that simply earning or inheriting more money doesn't automatically fix your relationship with it.

I realized that I needed to learn to better trust my own judgement, and to trust the changes that I had made. I looked back over the previous two years, thinking about mistakes I had made in the past, and asking myself whether I'd make those same errors of judgment again. I realized that no, I wouldn't. I saw clearly, perhaps for the first time, how much had changed, from the external circumstances that dictated my